times.’[1]

Two days later, on 5 April, the country once again came together to adhere to the prime minister’s call for unity. The visuals which came in via media outlets were particularly moving. Entire streets were lit up with diyas and torchlights. People even came out to their balconies to play conch shells, ghantis and thaalis and clapped too. Neighbours looked at each other appreciatively, knowing very well that although at the moment they were separated physically by the walls of their respective homes, they were in this fight together. Cities and villages alike reverberated with the positive, hopeful energy—world over it has left observers boggled even after two years of the pandemic as to how a country like India stayed the official line and stood firmly behind our prime minister to together fight the virus. A feat difficult for many large nations to achieve. Out of the many images which cropped up, a certain one with an old, raggedy woman standing outside her hut with a diya in her hand and hope in her eyes particularly touched many hearts, conveying the true spirit of the prime minister’s intended exercise.

The PM also joined in and visuals of him lighting a diya at his official residence went viral, gathering around six million likes on his Instagram account, one of the highest ever. Across the country, similar visuals of various chief ministers, Union ministers, film personalities, cricketers and business leaders were also being flashed in the media.

Some people observed that the atmosphere across the country was as if Diwali had arrived early in the year. It appeared as if, for those brief moments, there was no fear or trepidation among the people. As if there was no uncertainty and anxiety relating to the deadly virus. In that moment, the entire nation was united in feeling hopeful and optimistic. Perhaps this was what the prime minister had in mind when he planned it: to instill positivity among the people despite the despair all around. The upbeat energy also encouraged patience in society.

In contrast, some sections worked overtime to peddle fear in an already anxious population. Shashi Tharoor[2], India Today’s news anchor Rajdeep Sardesai[3], a state minister for Energy in the Maharashtra Vikas Aghadi (MVA) government from the Congress party and several other ill-informed media influencers touted rumours that India may face a severe grid crisis owing to the lights-out call given by the prime minister. The Union Power